

went at 7.43 runs per over across the tournament, more than all four semifinalists, and came undone when put under pressure by opposition batters.

More than execution, however, India's problems lay in its planning. It fielded a different bowling combination in all five matches, altering both its seam attack and new-ball pairing each time.

The seam attack was a particular concern, as Renuka Singh, Kranti Gaud, Arundhati Reddy, and Nandni Sharma managed a collective five wickets at an average of 47. That none of them took the new ball more than twice was evidence that India lacked a settled PowerPlay strategy.

One mitigating factor is that Kashvee Gautam and Amanjot Kaur, both of whom have been part of the team in recent times, missed the tournament through injury, while Shreyanka Patil suffered an ankle injury midway through the World Cup, affecting the balance of the side.

The biggest positive, meanwhile, was the emergence of N. Shree Charani, who finished the league phase as the leading wicket-taker (14 wickets) and broke the record for the most wickets by an Indian bowler in a single edition of the Women's T20 World Cup.

The bowling attack's struggles were exacerbated by some poor fielding displays. India dropped 10 catches across the tournament. The low point came against Bangladesh, when it spilled four chances in five overs, before twice putting down Marizanne Kapp against South Africa.

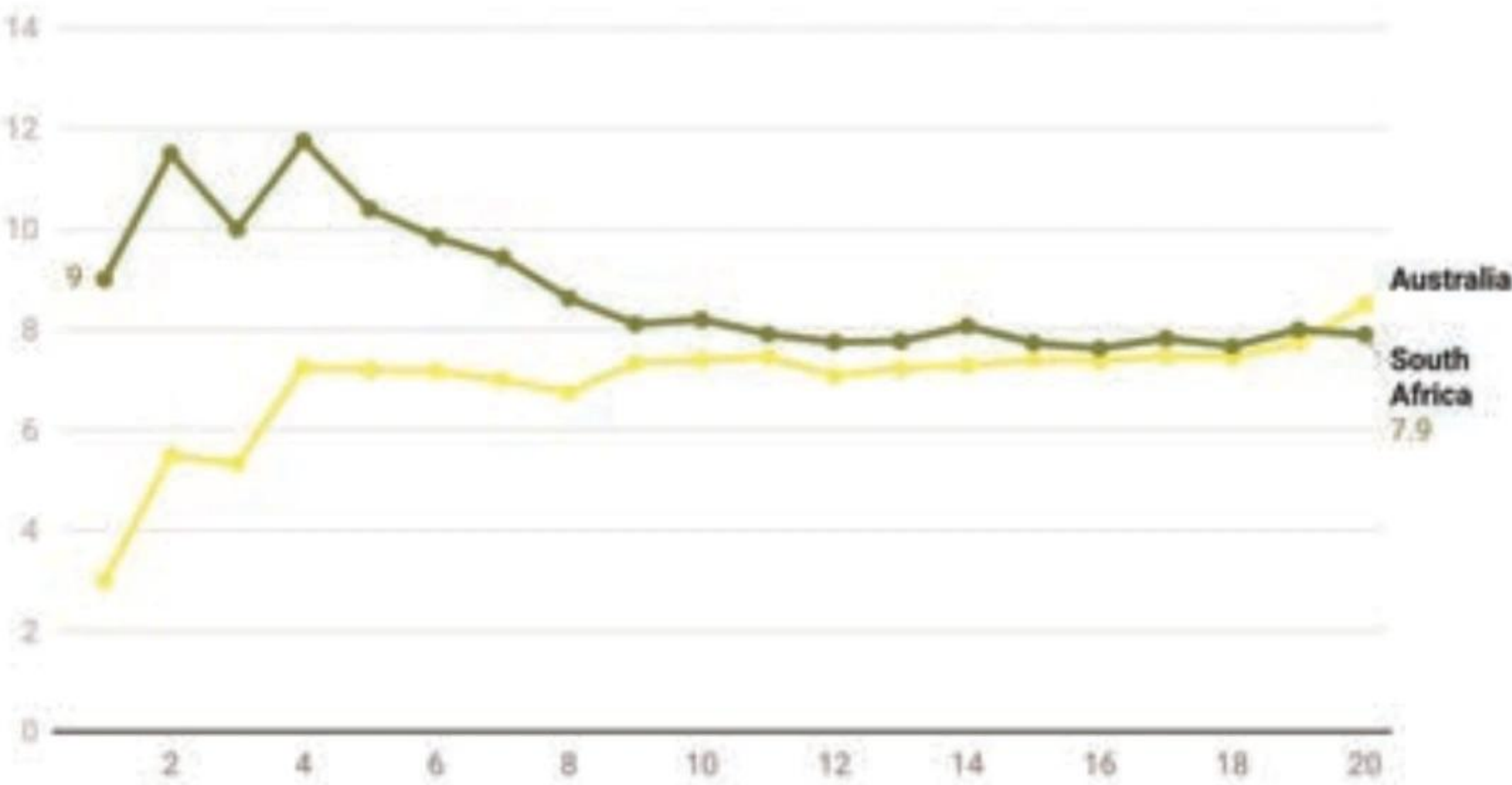
A reset to come?

In the aftermath of this elimination, it seems unquestionable that change is around the corner. Both captain and coach alluded to it after the match, speaking of the need for a "reset" and "rethink" of India's T20 plans.

Exactly what that reset looks like remains unclear, but with its next T20 assignment against Zimbabwe scheduled for October, and a 20-over Champions Trophy in 2027, the time is now for India to begin reworking its T20 strategy.

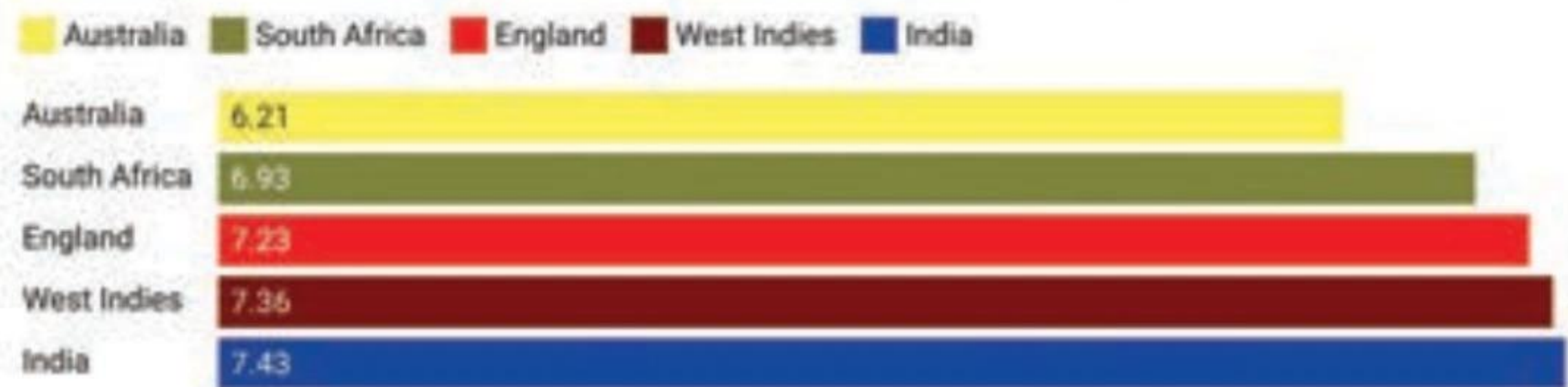
India's run-rate progression against South Africa and Australia

India struggled to provide the final flourish in its matches against South Africa and Australia, leaving it at a par total on both occasions.



Runs conceded per over at the Women's T20 World Cup 2026

India (7.43) conceded more runs per over than all four of the semifinalists of the Women's T20 World Cup 2026.



Muddled bowling plans: India's bowling combinations at the Women's T20 World Cup 2026

India chopped and changed its bowling combination, fielding a different seam-bowling and new-ball pair in every match.

Match	Pacers	Spinners	New-ball pair
Pakistan	Arundhati, Kranti	Shafali, Shreyanka, Shree Charani, Deepti	Arundhati, Shreyanka
Netherlands	Kranti, Nandni	Shafali, Shreyanka, Shree Charani, Deepti	Kranti, Nandni
South Africa	Nandni, Arundhati	Shafali, Shree Charani, Prema, Deepti	Shafali, Nandni
Bangladesh	Renuka, Nandni	Shafali, Shree Charani, Radha, Deepti	Shafali, Renuka
Australia	Renuka, Kranti	Shafali, Shree Charani, Radha, Deepti	Renuka, Kranti